

The First Home Buyer's 90-Day Checklist — Tasmania

Everything you need to sort before you sign — with important settings changing right now.

Correct as at July 2026. Tasmania's first home buyer grant and stamp duty exemption are transitioning at exactly this point in time — this checklist flags what's known and what still needs direct confirmation. Always check current details with the State Revenue Office Tasmania (sro.tas.gov.au) before relying on this for a purchase decision. This checklist is general information, not financial or legal advice.

⚠ Important: You're Reading This Right at a Policy Transition Point

Two of Tasmania's biggest first-home-buyer supports were **explicitly time-limited to end on 30 June 2026** — right around when this checklist was written. Here's exactly what was known as at July 2026, and what you need to verify before acting:

- ☐ [] **The First Home Owner Grant was \$30,000 up to 30 June 2026.** A reduced grant of **\$20,000 from 1 July 2026** had been **proposed but was subject to legislation** as at the time of writing. **Confirm the current, legislated grant amount directly with the SRO Tasmania before budgeting around any specific figure.**
- ☐ [] **The 100% stamp duty exemption on established homes (up to \$750,000) was confirmed to expire on 30 June 2026, with the SRO explicitly stating it would not be extended.** This means if you're purchasing after this date, you should assume standard transfer duty rates apply to established homes **unless you can confirm a replacement concession has since been legislated.**
- ☐ [] **The 50% pre-completion duty concession for off-the-plan apartments/units under construction (up to \$750,000) was also set to end 30 June 2026** — confirm current status.

Practical takeaway: don't rely on old headline figures you may have seen elsewhere. This is a genuinely live area — check the SRO Tasmania website directly, ideally with your conveyancer, before making any purchase decision based on assumed grant or duty savings.

Section 1 — Get Your Foundations Right (Do this first, before house-hunting)

- ☐ [] **Check your borrowing capacity with 2-3 lenders or a mortgage broker.**
- ☐ [] **Confirm the current First Home Owner Grant amount and eligibility directly with the SRO** given the transition described above.
- ☐ [] **Confirm current stamp duty settings for established homes directly with the SRO** — don't assume either the old exemption or a specific new concession applies without checking.
- ☐ [] **Check the federal First Home Guarantee** (5% deposit, no LMI) — confirm current Tasmania price caps with a participating lender; this federal scheme operates independently of state-level changes.
- ☐ [] **Consider the First Home Super Saver Scheme (FHSSS)** if still building your deposit.
- ☐ [] **Get formal pre-approval, not just an estimate,** given how much your total cost picture depends on confirming current state settings.

Section 2 — While You're Searching

- ☐ [] **Set a firm maximum price** based on your pre-approval and current (confirmed) duty settings — don't budget based on savings you haven't verified are still available.
- ☐ [] **Budget for the possibility that stamp duty relief on established homes may no longer apply** — build a "full duty" scenario into your budget as a safety margin until you've confirmed your specific situation with the SRO.
- ☐ [] **Budget for costs beyond the purchase price:** conveyancing fees, building and pest inspections, loan fees, and moving costs.

Section 3 — Know Your Legal Protections Before You Sign

- ☐ [] **Understand Tasmania has no statutory cooling-off period,** similar to Western Australia. Once you sign a contract of sale, you're bound — there's no window to withdraw.
- ☐ [] **Make every condition explicit in the contract before you sign** — finance approval, building/pest inspection, and anything else you need must be written into the contract itself.
- ☐ [] **Get your building and pest inspection arranged before you sign,** or ensure a robust, clearly time-limited inspection condition is built into the contract.
- ☐ [] **Have a conveyancer or solicitor review the contract before you sign,** not after — critical given there's no cooling-off safety net.

Section 4 — Between Signing and Settlement

- ☐ [] **Confirm building insurance timing with your conveyancer.**
- ☐ [] **Finalise unconditional loan approval** well before settlement.
- ☐ [] **Book a pre-settlement inspection** in the days before settlement.
- ☐ [] **Confirm who's lodging your grant and any duty relief paperwork,** and confirm the amounts being applied for match current legislated settings, not outdated figures.

Section 5 — Common First-Home-Buyer Mistakes to Avoid

- ☐ [] **Don't assume WA-style "no cooling-off" understanding covers you here** — same rule applies in Tasmania, so treat pre-signature diligence as essential.
- ☐ [] **Don't budget around headline grant/duty figures without direct confirmation** — this is the single most important caution for Tasmanian first home buyers reading this checklist in mid-to-late 2026.

☐ [] **Don't sign before your inspection and finance conditions are properly documented in the contract.**

Quick Reference — Tasmania First Home Buyer Support (STATUS AS AT JULY 2026 — VERIFY BEFORE RELYING)

SUPPORT	STATUS AS AT JULY 2026
First Home Owner Grant	\$30,000 up to 30 June 2026; \$20,000 proposed from 1 July 2026, subject to legislation — confirm current amount
Stamp duty exemption (established homes, ≤\$750,000)	Confirmed to expire 30 June 2026, not to be extended per SRO — confirm current position
Off-the-plan/pre-completion concession (≤\$750,000)	Also set to end 30 June 2026 — confirm current status
Cooling-off period	None

Sources: State Revenue Office Tasmania (sro.tas.gov.au). This table reflects publicly available information current up to the transition date — direct verification with the SRO is essential given the active transition.

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